BIOLOGICAL/PHYSICAL FALSE BELIEF #9 · CHRONIC PAIN

“If doctors can't find the cause, it must be all in my head.”

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Where it often comes from

Pain without a clear test result is common. When scans are normal, some patients are dismissed, and many begin to doubt themselves. Self-doubt can lead to shame, silence, and stopping the search for help.

What Scripture teaches

Jesus took seriously the suffering of the woman with bleeding who had spent everything on doctors and was no better, and He said, “your faith has healed you. Go in peace and be free of your affliction” (Mark 5:34). Pain is real whether or not it appears on a test. Scripture says, “I am weary from groaning” (Psalm 6:6) and “He heals the brokenhearted and binds up their wounds.” God is a compassionate Father who believes you, even when others struggle to. Keep seeking help, because medicine does not know everything.

> *“‘Daughter,’ said Jesus, ‘your faith has healed you. Go in peace and be free of your affliction.’”* (Mark 5:34).

Also see

> “I am weary from groaning; all night I flood my bed with weeping and drench my couch with tears” (Psalm 6:6).

> “He heals the brokenhearted and binds up their wounds” (Psalm 147:3).

> “For we do not have a high priest who is unable to sympathize with our weaknesses, but we have one who was tempted in every way that we are, yet was without sin” (Hebrews 4:15).

> “Plans fail for lack of counsel, but with many advisers they succeed” (Proverbs 15:22).

Common self-statements

- No test shows anything, so I am imagining it.
- I must be crazy.
- I am exaggerating.
- The doctors are right and I am wrong.
- I should stop complaining.
- Nobody can help me.

Common logical errors

- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing pain is either visible on tests or imaginary.
- Fortune telling: Predicting that no one will ever believe me.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling dismissed and concluding I am imagining it.
- Mind reading: Calling myself a complainer.

Challenging questions

- What do I know about my pain from my own experience?
- Who has believed me and taken me seriously?
- What have I not yet tried, such as a pain specialist or a second opinion?

- What do I want to say to my care team?
- What does Jesus' care for the suffering woman say about my pain?
- Who can go to appointments with me?

Truth summary

> My pain is real, even when tests are normal. I can keep seeking help, speak plainly with my care team, and rest in a God who believes me and cares.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Sickness
- Suffering
- Therapy
- Wisdom
- Hardship

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Weak/Tired
- Divorce

Listen: Overcoming Depression

> Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Just Be Held — Casting Crowns
God's care remains when control, strength, or explanations run out.

Praise You in This Storm — Casting Crowns featuring Phil Wickham
Suffering and tears do not establish that God is absent or uncaring.

I Am Not Alone — Kari Jobe
God's companionship remains through darkness, weakness, and uncertainty.

Blessed Assurance — Larry Ford and Lillie Knauls with Gaither
This classic hymn celebrates belonging to Christ and resting in His salvation.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "If doctors can't find the cause, it must be all in my head"

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Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"If doctors can't find the cause, it must be all in my head." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What do I know about my pain from my own experience?
- ☐ Who has believed me and taken me seriously?
- ☐ What have I not yet tried, such as a pain specialist or a second opinion?
- ☐ What do I want to say to my care team?
- ☐ What does Jesus' care for the suffering woman say about my pain?
- ☐ Who can go to appointments with me?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ My pain is real.
- ☐ Jesus cares for those who suffer.
- ☐ God binds up the brokenhearted.
- ☐ Seeking counsel is wise.
- ☐ I can keep looking for help.
- ☐ God does not dismiss me.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ Mark 5:34
  "'Daughter,' said Jesus, 'your faith has healed you. Go in peace and be free of your affliction.'"
- ☐ Psalm 6:6
  "I am weary from groaning; all night I flood my bed with weeping and drench my couch with tears."
- ☐ Psalm 147:3
  "He heals the brokenhearted and binds up their wounds."

A verse I found myself: _____

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

Practicing the Truth

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5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- ☐ Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- ☐ Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- ☐ Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- ☐ Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- ☐ Heard and helped: Each week, note one step you took to get care.
- ☐ My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.
  For example, Mark 5:34 becomes: "Sarah can write: "Jesus cares about my suffering, seen or unseen.""
- ☐ Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- ☐ Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- ☐ Reading: The "Sickness" topic in Pearls.
- ☐ Listening: The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

These cards support emotional and spiritual care and do not replace medical care. Follow your doctor's advice about treatment and medication, and choose steps that are safe for your body. In an emergency call 911; for thoughts of self-harm call or text 988 (U.S.).

- ☐ Write your story. List symptoms, timing, and what helps.
- ☐ Bring someone. Take a friend to an appointment.
- ☐ Seek another opinion. Ask about specialists or pain clinics.
- ☐ Pray Psalm 147:3. Rest in God's care.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "If doctors can't find the cause, it must be all in my head": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	Heard and helped
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~If doctors can't find the cause, it must be all in my head.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, no one can find the cause, but You know my pain. Give me persistence, wise doctors, and people who believe me. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.